AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

MAY 2014

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 15 minutes Marks: 50

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use ONLY black ink.
   Do not use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   DO NOT write outside the answer box.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 18 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow:

From an early age, I spent most of my free time in the field playing and fighting with the other boys of the village. A boy who remained at home tied to his mother's apron strings was regarded as a sissy. At night, I shared my food and blanket with these same boys. I was no more than five when I became a herd-boy, looking after sheep and calves in the fields. I discovered the almost mystical attachment that the Xhosa have for cattle, not only as a source of food and wealth, but as a blessing from God and a source of happiness. It was in the fields that I learned how to knock birds out of the sky with a slingshot, to gather wild honey and fruits and edible roots, to drink warm, sweet milk straight from the udder of a cow, to swim in the clear, cold streams, and to catch fish with twine and sharpened bits of wire. I learned to stick-fight--essential knowledge to any rural African boy - and became adept at its various techniques, parrying blows, feinting in one direction and striking in another, breaking away from an opponent with quick footwork. From these days I date my love of the field, of open spaces, the simple beauties of nature, the clean line of the horizon.

As boys, we were mostly left to our own devices. We played with toys we made ourselves. We molded animals and birds out of clay. We made ox-drawn sleighs out of tree branches. Nature was our playground. The hills above Qunu were dotted with large smooth rocks which we transformed into our own roller coaster. We sat on flat stones and slid down the face of the large rocks. We did this until our backsides were so sore we could hardly sit down. I learned to ride by sitting atop weaned calves-- after being thrown to the ground several times, one got the hang of it.

I learned my lesson one day from an unruly donkey. We had been taking turns climbing up and down its back and when my chance came I jumped on and the donkey bolted into a nearby thornbush. It bent its head, trying to unseat me, which it did, but not before the thorns had pricked and scratched my face, embarrassing me in front of my friends. Like the people of the East, Africans have a highly developed sense of dignity, or what the Chinese call "face." I had lost face among my friends. Even though it was a donkey that unseated me, I learned that to humiliate another person is to make him suffer an unnecessarily cruel fate. Even as a boy, I defeated my opponents without dishonoring them.

Like all Xhosa children, I acquired knowledge mainly through observation. We were meant to learn through imitation and emulation, not through questions. When I first visited the homes of whites, I was often dumbfounded by the number and nature of questions that children asked of their parents--and their parents' unfailing willingness to answer them. In my household, questions were considered a nuisance; adults imparted information as they considered necessary.

My life, and that of most Xhosas at the time, was shaped by custom, ritual, and taboo. This was the alpha and omega of our existence, and went unquestioned. Men followed the path laid out for them by their fathers; women led the same lives as their mothers had before them.

Adapted from ‘Long Walk to Freedom’ by Nelson Mandela

a. Describe the young Nelson Mandela's personality with the help of textual evidences. (5 Marks)

b. What gave the narrator's self-esteem a blow? What did he learn from it? (4 Marks)

c. Mention any FIVE features of African society that have been presented in the passage. (5 Marks)

d. Why was Nelson Mandela surprised when he visited the homes of white people? How do you feel about the habit of white people which surprised Mandela? (4 Marks)

Q.2. (Total 14 Marks)

Compose a response of about 150 words to any ONE of the options a or b.

EITHER

a. There are various educational benefits of watching movies. However, due to study pressure often students miss out on watching good movies. Write a letter to the Principal of your school and request him / her to designate few hours of a particular day in a month for watching movies. State what types of movies you want to watch by naming a few and state how could they benefit you academically or otherwise.

OR

b. There have been some unusual activities every night in the entire past week near your home. They happen at the same time every night. Your family members and neighbours are very upset. Last night, you saw something unusual again and decided to report it to the police. Write your report giving all the details of what you saw, who was involved and how it could be tackled.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 6 and 7.

Option _____

Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200-250 words on any ONE of the options a, b or c.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. "Charity is a helping hand stretched out to save some from the inferno of their present life." People have mixed opinions about helping the street beggars. Analyse your encounter(s) with street beggars and mention your views about what types of beggars are present around us. Which ones deserve most help? Which ones do not deserve any help?

OR

b. Few years back foreign television serials were considered to be a threat to Pakistani television serials. Viewers and sponsors both were inclined towards foreign television. However, in recent years Pakistani dramas have made a comeback. Do you agree that the quality and entertainment value of Pakistani television shows have become better in the recent years? Which Pakistani drama (old or new) do you like the most? Explain in what ways are Pakistani dramas different?

OR

c. Pakistan has many rural sports that are not only exciting but also represent the original flavour of sports in the sub-continent. Write about one rural sport that you like and express why you like it? Explain the rules of playing that game.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 9 and 10.

Option _____

END OF PAPER

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